

Options for the Development of National Standards and Guidelines for Animal Welfare

AWTG 25-01 noted a discussion by members on next steps in the staged approach to improvements to the national standards development process. A meeting of the subgroup will be scheduled to facilitate further in-depth discussions.

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments

AWTG 25-01 noted an update from Queensland that jurisdictions will work collaboratively to incorporate their feedback on a third draft of the standards and continue to progress the project towards public consultation.

Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock - horses

AWTG 25-01 noted an update from Queensland that ministers continue to work towards national endorsement of amendments to the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock to improve the welfare of horses.

Virtual Fencing Technology

AWTG 25-01 noted an update from the Commonwealth that AWTG feedback will be incorporated into the draft Australian Animal Welfare Guide for Virtual Fencing. Feedback on the draft guide will be sought from the stakeholder reference group shortly.

Implementation of the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Poultry into state and territory legislation

AWTG 25-01 noted an update from Victoria regarding the work of the poultry implementation subgroup which is considering cross-jurisdictional issues.

Renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS)

AWTG 25-01 noted an update from the Commonwealth that the National Statement on Animal Welfare was endorsed by all Agriculture Ministers and published on 13 December 2024. Next steps for AAWS

development during 2025 include work on individual animal group 'chapters' with practical actions. These will be developed in consultation with stakeholders, with AWTG continuing its governance role.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/welfare/awtg/communique-february-2025>